

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: RESPONSIBLE EXECUTIVE: CORE CONCEPT AND ORIGIN

- START -> British cabinet convention separated the dignified head from the responsible ministry;
India's Constitution codified the relationship.
- > Article 53: Union executive power is formally vested in the President.
 - > Article 74: a Council headed by the Prime Minister aids and advises the President.
 - > Article 75(3): the Council is collectively responsible to Lok Sabha.
 - > Answer line: The President supplies constitutional form, while the PM-led Council supplies responsible political choice and Lok Sabha accountability.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: TIMELINE: TEXT, AMENDMENT, CASE AND PRACTICE

START -> 1950: Articles 74-75, 77-78 and 88 commence.

-> 1961: Allocation of Business and Transaction of Business Rules operationalise Article 77(3).

-> U. N. R. Rao (1971): Lok Sabha dissolution does not remove the need for a Council.

-> Shamsher Singh (1974): President and Governor ordinarily act on responsible ministerial advice.

-> 1976 42nd Amendment: Article 74(1) expressly requires action according to advice.

-> 1978 44th Amendment: Article 74(1) proviso permits one reconsideration; reiterated advice binds; Article 352(3) requires written Cabinet decision.

-> S. P. Anand (1996): a non-member may be PM subject to six consecutive months.

-> S.R. Chaudhuri (2001): State analogue rejects serial six-month reappointments; B. R. Kapur (2001): disqualification cannot be bypassed.

-> 2003 91st Amendment: Article 75(1A) size cap and 75(1B) defector bar.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: DECODED UNION CONSTITUTIONAL SPINE

- START -> Article 74(1): PM-headed Council advises; President may return advice once under the 44th Amendment proviso.
- > Article 74(2): courts cannot inquire whether or what advice was tendered; resulting action is not automatically immune.
 - > Article 75(1): President appoints PM; other ministers are appointed on PM's advice.
 - > Article 75(2)-(6): pleasure, Lok Sabha responsibility, oaths, six-month rule and salaries by parliamentary law.
 - > Article 77: Union action in President's name, authentication and business rules.
 - > Article 78: PM must communicate, furnish information and collectivise specified individual decisions.
 - > Article 88: ministers and Attorney-General may participate across Houses; voting follows membership.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: FORMATION, MEMBERSHIP, TENURE AND DISSOLUTION

- START -> Clear majority: recognised leader is invited; a hung House activates bounded presidential judgment.
- > Objective support -> appointment -> prompt floor test; S.R. Bommai (1994) supplies the broader State-context floor-test principle.
 - > PM may belong to either House; Article 75(5) allows a non-member only six consecutive months.
 - > Article 75(4) + Third Schedule: President administers oaths of office and secrecy.
 - > Article 75(6) + Salaries and Allowances of Ministers Act, 1952: pay is governed by parliamentary law.
 - > PM resignation/death ends the ministry politically; one minister's exit does not.
 - > Dissolution advice concerns Lok Sabha; Rajya Sabha is continuing; viable alternative support is relevant in a defeated/caretaker context.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: RESPONSIBILITY, ADVICE SECRECY AND PARLIAMENT

- START -> Collective: Article 75(3) -> confidence, solidarity and unified accountability to Lok Sabha.
- > Individual: Article 75(2) -> one minister may leave through PM-led pleasure without ending the Council.
 - > Legal: no universal countersignature; ordinary criminal, civil, statutory and public-law accountability remains.
 - > Article 74(2) protects advice from judicial inquiry; Article 75(4) oath protects official secrecy; neither creates blanket secrecy over all underlying material.
 - > Article 76 creates the Attorney-General as the Union's chief legal adviser; Article 88 gives that office and ministers participation across Houses without an office-based vote.
 - > Ambedkar's 1951 resignation illustrates solidarity through exit after fundamental disagreement.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: COUNCIL, CABINET, RANKS AND 91ST AMENDMENT

- START -> Council of Ministers: wider constitutional ministry under Articles 74-75; bears collective responsibility.
- > Cabinet: PM plus Cabinet-rank decision core; expressly defined for Article 352(3)'s written emergency advice.
 - > Minister of State may hold independent charge or be attached; Deputy Minister is conventional; Deputy PM has no separate constitutional power.
 - > Article 75(1A), 91st Amendment (2003): PM plus all Union ministers $\leq$ 15% of total Lok Sabha membership; no Union minimum.
 - > Article 75(1B): specified Tenth Schedule defector is barred from ministership for the constitutional period.
 - > Prelims firewall: conventional ranks are not a four-rank constitutional classification.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: PRIME MINISTER'S POWER AND POSITION

- START -> Ministry: recommends appointments, allocates/reshuffles portfolios, chairs Cabinet and coordinates policy.
- > President: sole Article 78 information channel; advice operates through the Council.
 - > Parliament: leads government programme and confidence; advises summoning/prorogation/dissolution within the parliamentary system.
 - > Party/coalition: control varies with majority, allies, outside support and internal party authority.
 - > Nation: political leadership in crises, intergovernmental coordination and international representation.
 - > Qualified verdict: constitutional centrality plus political elasticity; no unlimited personal power.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: ARTICLE 77 BUSINESS MACHINERY

START -> Article 77(1): executive action is expressed in the President's name; this is institutional form, not personal decision.

- > Article 77(2): instruments are authenticated under rules; authentication does not erase underlying legality.
- > Article 77(3): rules allocate and transact Union business.
- > Allocation of Business Rules, 1961: which ministry/department owns a subject.
- > Transaction of Business Rules, 1961: departmental disposal, consultation and cases requiring PM, committee, Cabinet or President approval.
- > Flow: department -> consultation -> escalation -> recorded decision -> implementation -> monitoring.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: COMMITTEES, SECRETARIAT, PMO AND INFORMAL CORE

- START -> Cabinet Committees: standing/ad hoc ministerial bodies; extra-constitutional; specialise and coordinate; composition is notification-sensitive.
- > Official control: Cabinet Secretariat composition document dated 27 July 2026; never freeze number, members or chair.
 - > Cabinet Secretariat: administers business rules, agendas, records, coordination, crisis support and implementation monitoring.
 - > PMO: non-constitutional staff office supporting PM; influence is not independent legal competence.
 - > Kitchen cabinet: informal trusted circle, possibly including outsiders; substantive decisions must return to formal channels.
 - > Groups of Ministers: ad hoc cross-portfolio devices; Second ARC favoured selective, time-bound use.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: POLITICAL CONTEXTS AND CONTINUITY

- START -> Cohesive majority -> strongest PM personnel, party and agenda leverage.
- > Coalition -> negotiated portfolios, common programme and ally veto points; Article 75(3) remains intact.
 - > Minority -> issue-based/outside support may sustain confidence; largest-party status alone is insufficient.
 - > Caretaker -> legal continuity with conventional restraint on major irreversible decisions unless necessary.
 - > U. N. R. Rao (1971): a Council remains constitutionally necessary after Lok Sabha dissolution.
 - > Confidence loss -> resignation or constitutionally proper dissolution route; viable alternative support must be objectively assessed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: UNION-STATE MIRRORS, CASES AND EXAMINER TRAPS

- START -> Article 74 / 163: PM-Council advice to President / CM-Council advice to Governor, with bounded State discretion.
- > Article 75 / 164: Lok Sabha / Assembly responsibility; State cap also has minimum twelve.
 - > Article 77 / 166: Union / State action and business rules.
 - > Article 78 / 167: PM / CM information duties.
 - > Article 88 / 177: participation across Houses; vote only through membership.
 - > Shamsher Singh (1974): advice default; S. P. Anand (1996): non-member PM valid for six months; Devi Lal (1990): Deputy PM label adds no power.
 - > Traps: Article 74 secrecy != act immunity; Council != Cabinet; Cabinet Committee != parliamentary committee; PM may sit in either House.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: MAINS ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

START -> Start with decoded Article and direct thesis.

-> Add named amendment, case, commission, rule or institutional example.

-> Explain mechanism: personnel, confidence, information, business routing, scrutiny or coalition arithmetic.

-> Qualify by text, State-context boundary, convention, dynamic notification or institutional counterweight.

-> Use 2024 GS-II route: fusion + whip + agenda/time control -> reduced deliberation -> committees/no-confidence/courts as correctives.

-> Reform: sittings, committee referral, narrower survival whip, traceable business rules, PMO subsidiarity and reviewed GoMs.

-> Verdict: strong coordination is legitimate only while decisions remain formally competent and collectively accountable.